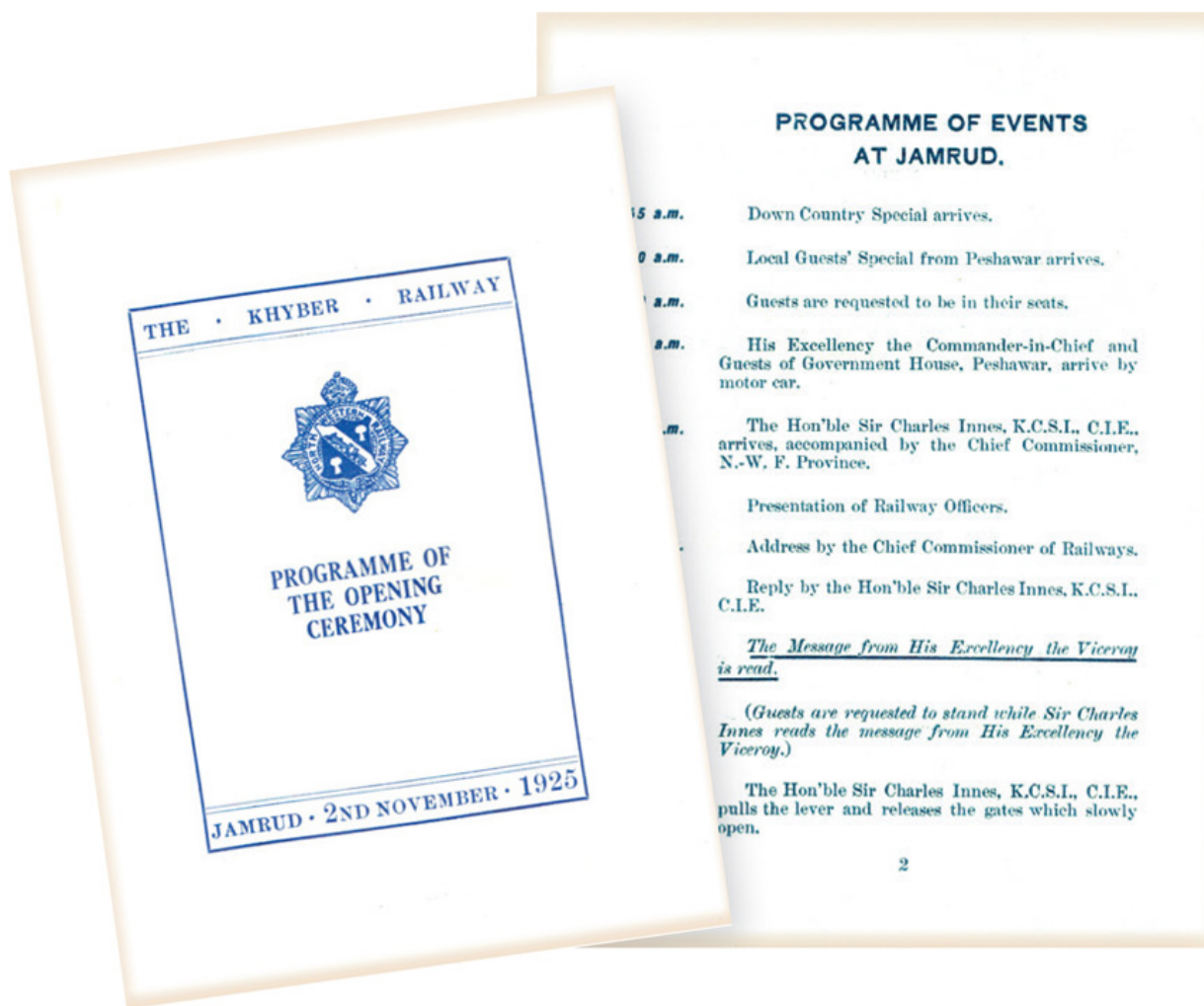




▲ **An opening ceremony programme** provides details of the Khyber Pass Railway's launch, which was held on 2 November 1925.

Building through the Khyber

Construction began in 1920. The nearly 40-km-line would begin at Jamrud and end at Landi Khana, a town in modern-day Pakistan almost 3 km short of the frontier post. It would take four reversing stations, 34 tunnels about 5-km-long, 92 bridges and culverts, and four watering stations for locomotives to cross the Khyber. British author PSA Berridge wrote about a ruling gradient of 3 per cent between Jamrud and Landi Kotal (in Pakistan) with a rise of about 600 m in 34 km and a descent of 265 m to Landi Khana. A large part of the construction involved delicate negotiations with the Pashtun tribes. Bayley brought some of them on